CHECKLIST · BEST CRM FOR 2027

Sales CRM or Customer Engagement Platform?

Tick every statement that is true for your business today. Count the ticks in each column.

	Sales CRM	Customer Engagement Platform
1. Who closes the deal	☐ A sales rep follows up, negotiates and closes	☐ Customers pay without talking to anyone
2. What triggers action	☐ A deal moves to a new pipeline stage	☐ A user does (or skips) something in the product, e.g. drops off mid-KYC
3. Main channels	☐ Email, phone calls and meetings	☐ Push, WhatsApp, SMS, in-app and email at scale
4. How success is measured	☐ Pipeline value, win rate, forecast accuracy	☐ Activation, retention, repeat purchase
5. Team and setup	☐ Founder-led sales or a small team of reps	☐ Growth / lifecycle team with product event data

Your score

Sales CRM ticks: ____ / 5

CEP ticks: ____ / 5

Mostly Sales CRM	Start with a Sales CRM: HubSpot, Pipedrive, Close, Salesforce or Zoho.
Mostly CEP	Start with a CEP: Braze, MoEngage, CleverTap, Customer.io or WebEngage.
Even split	You may need both. Pick the one tied to how you make money today, connect the other later.

Quick test: if your best customers talked to a person before paying, start with a Sales CRM. If they paid without talking to anyone, start with a CEP. Confirm current pricing and WhatsApp support with each vendor before you buy.